

Our Brains in the AI Era

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I work with AI users a *lot*

85% of developers use AI
regularly¹

¹ JetBrains' State of the Developer Ecosystem Report 2025

Spain is the 6th most "AI-diffused" country in the world with 41.8% of the population having used generative AI²

² Microsoft AI Economy Institute, Global AI Adoption in 2025 study

How did we get here?

The waves of AI

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- "Pair programming", fancy autocompletion
- "Peer programming", agents
- "Orchestration", fleets of agents

At GitHub

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- More than 2x PRs committed on average per engineer
- 2025: 1 billion commit mark
- Now: 275 million commits per week
- Copilot Code Review agent is #3 contributor to the codebase

What could possibly go wrong?

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- Debugging code you didn't write
- Defending decisions you didn't make
- *Too much* reduced **friction**

What could possibly go wrong?

In an MIT study, people wrote essays in two groups,
with and without LLMs.³

³ publichealthpolicyjournal.com/mit-study-finds-artificial-intelligence-use-reprograms-the-brain-leading-to-cognitive-decline

What could possibly go wrong?

- 83.3% of LLM users were unable to quote even one sentence
- 88.9% of "brain-only" users could quote accurately
- 0% of LLM users could produce a correct quote, while most "brain" users could

What could possibly go wrong?

- The story of a new learner
- OpenClaw writing a hit piece
- Job interview crutches
- Open source slop

“Once men turned their thinking over to machines in the hope that this would set them free. But that only permitted other men with machines to enslave them.”

— Frank Herbert, *Dune*

We have a duty in tech to be the
stewards of the future.

Only ~16% percent of the world
has ever used AI, ever.⁴

⁴ global-ai-adoption.netlify.app

We need to build the future we
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- Safety guardrails
- Sustainable tooling
- Accessible costs

We need to build the future we want to be a part of.

- Systems for communicating
- Forward-thinking hiring practices
- Mentorship pipelines

All of these concepts boil down to learning in public, more than ever.

Imagine your tools go down.

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- Could your knowledge get you through?
- Could your team, stakeholders, customers get you through?
- Could your records get you through?

Our brains are the only
intelligence tools we'll have
for our entire lives.

To scale our thinking, we have
to share our thinking.

Gracias <3

Tell me your thoughts!

`cass.run/cm`